

KIAN RAVAEI

**THREE
NOTHINGS**

for solo violoncello

ÆI edition

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NOTHINGS**

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(2025)

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Commissioned by John C. Robinson for Sarah Rommel.

PROGRAM NOTE

In this piece, I make a musical effort to understand the two periods of non-existence—before and after life—as well as the in-between we call existence, so momentary and Sisyphean that it too may be called a “nothing.”

—Kian Ravaei

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

My sincerest thanks to cellists Boubacar Diallo, Robert Feifan Hurley, Dylan Kinneavy, and Sarah Rommel, whose advice was essential in the creation of this work.

duration ca. 9'

to Sarah Rommel

THREE NOTHINGS

for solo cello

Kian Ravaei
(2025)

I. After Death

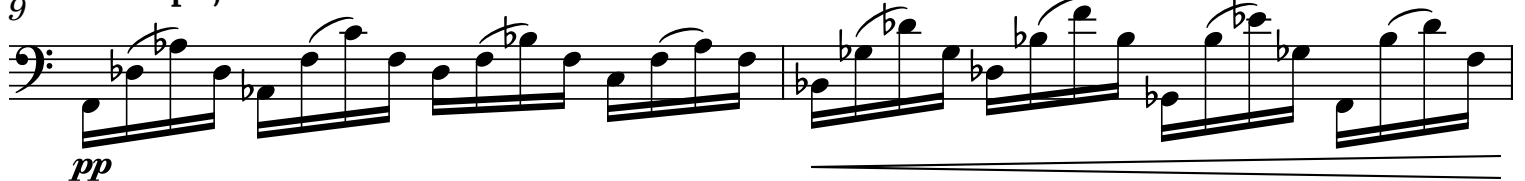
Grieving, with much rubato ♩ = 50–58



a tempo, aching



a tempo, somber



11

p *mf* rit.

a tempo, feeling new strength

13

f

15

ff *mf* ten. rit.

a tempo, tearful

17

p

19

rit. al fine

dim. *pp*

II. Sisyphus

Lumbering footsteps $\text{♩} = 54$ ($\text{♩} = 108$)

f heavy

10

20

29

Freely (sul A)

sf *p* ethereal

36 a tempo

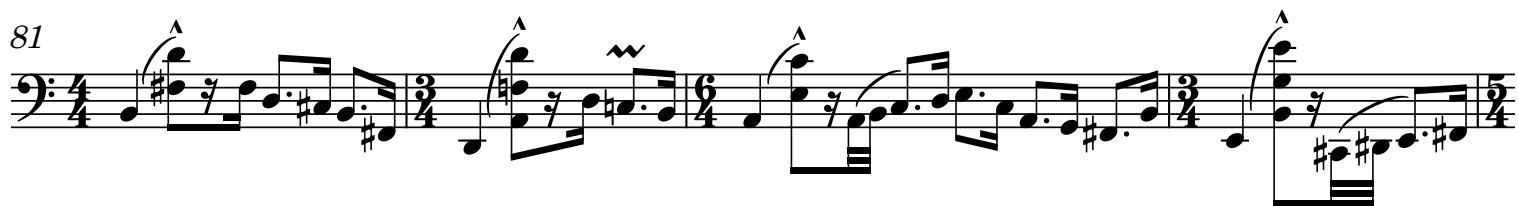
f heavy

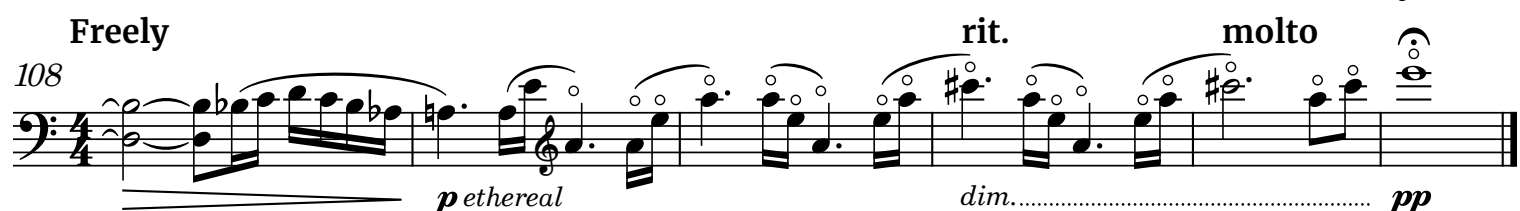
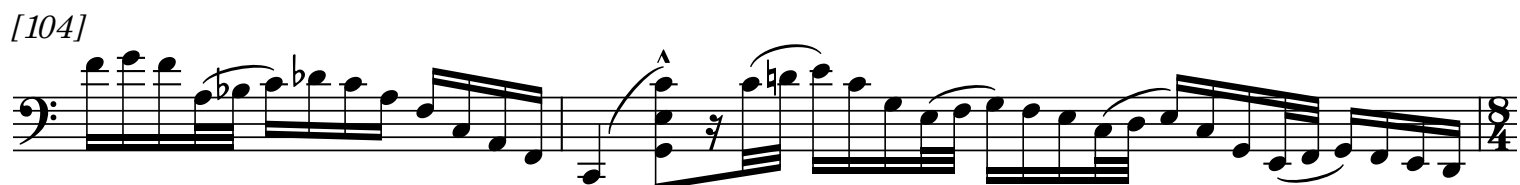
43

49

55

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in bass clef, with a key signature of one flat (B-flat). The tempo is marked 'Lumbering footsteps' with a half note equal to 54 beats (♩ = 54) and a quarter note equal to 108 beats (♩ = 108). The score is divided into systems of staves. The first system (measures 1-9) is marked *f* heavy. The second system (measures 10-19) continues the heavy texture. The third system (measures 20-28) also continues the heavy texture. The fourth system (measures 29-35) begins with a 'Freely' marking and a '(sul A)' instruction, transitioning to a more ethereal texture marked *p* ethereal, with a forte (*sf*) dynamic at the start of the section. The fifth system (measures 36-42) is marked 'a tempo' and returns to the heavy texture marked *f* heavy. The sixth system (measures 43-48) continues the heavy texture. The seventh system (measures 49-54) continues the heavy texture. The eighth system (measures 55-60) continues the heavy texture. The score includes various musical notations such as slurs, ties, and dynamic markings.





III. Before Birth (Bardo)

As fast as possible $\text{♩} = 144-152$ (ben misurato)

6 *mp*

11

16 17

21

26

31 33 *f*

36

41

46

Detailed description: This is a musical score for a piece titled 'III. Before Birth (Bardo)'. The tempo is marked 'As fast as possible' with a quarter note equal to 144-152 beats per minute, and the performance style is 'ben misurato'. The score is written in bass clef with a 2/2 time signature. It consists of 46 measures, divided into systems of four measures each. The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The score includes dynamic markings: *mp* (mezzo-piano) at the beginning and *f* (forte) starting at measure 33. There are also performance instructions: a 'V' (crescendo hairpin) at the start and a double bar line with a repeat sign at measure 33. The notation features many beamed eighth and sixteenth notes, creating a rapid, rhythmic texture.

51

56

61

p *ff* *p*

rit.

66 a tempo

mp

71

76

81

82

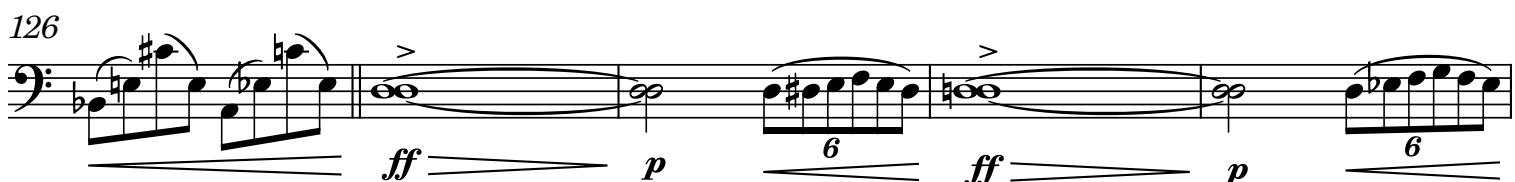
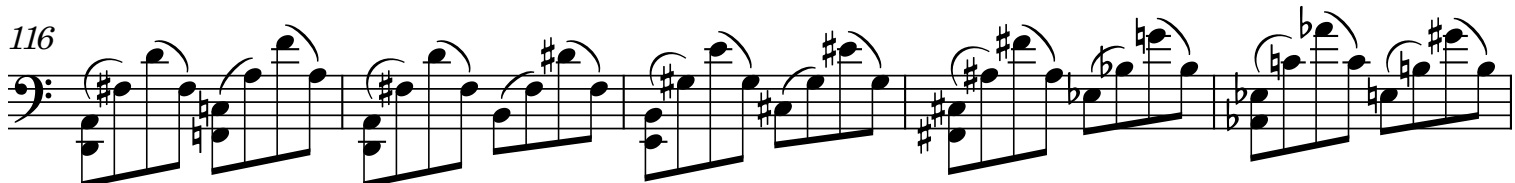
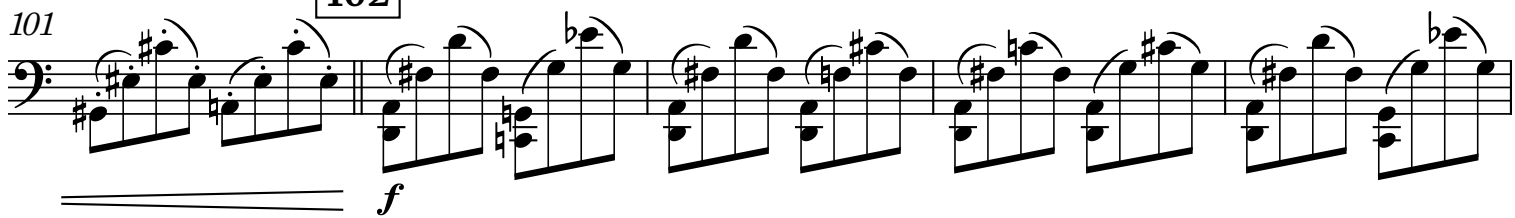
86

91

96

The musical score is written for a bass clef instrument. It consists of measures 51 through 96. The key signature has one flat (B-flat). The time signature is not explicitly shown but appears to be 4/4. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and dynamic markings (p, ff, mp). A section starting at measure 66 is marked 'a tempo'. A measure at measure 82 is boxed and labeled '82'. The score ends with a double bar line at measure 96.

102



rit.

135 a tempo



